

The wrong bishop and rook pawn

Endgame Technique

THE IDEA

A bishop may be unable to help a rook pawn promote when it cannot control the promotion corner and the defending king reaches that corner. This is a major drawing resource, but it depends on the exact position and absence of other winning resources.

WORKED EXAMPLE

White's a-pawn promotes on dark a8. A light-squared bishop cannot drive a black king from a8 by controlling that square. If the king is securely established there, extra material may not be enough to win.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you inspect before trading into bishop and rook pawn versus king?

ANSWER AND REASONING

The bishop's color, the promotion square's color, the defending king's access to the corner, and whether other pawns can change the situation. Prevent the fortress before it is established.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Match the bishop to the promotion square before simplifying.